special signs and symbols. The signs bear some pictorial resemblance to the original feature and their meaning is quiet clear. Some conventional signs need to be studied closely before they can be recognised.

Point, line and area symbols are used to depict various physical and cultural features. They can be in the form of alphabets, figures, signs or colour wash.

The Survey Of India (SOI) have standardised a set of conventional signs and symbols to be used in topographical maps.

Seven colours are commonly used in the maps of Survey of India.

- **Black** - All writings on the map except grid numbers (names, abbreviation such as DB, RS, PO), river banks, broken ground, dry streams, surveyed trees, heights and their numbering, railway lines, telephone and telegraph lines, lines of latitude and longitude, all boundaries, any written amplification (such as 'open scrub', 'metalled road under construction', 'meter guage' are given in black.
- **Brown** - Contour lines, their numbering, form lines, sand features and barren rocky areas such as hills and dunes are represented in brown.
- **Blue –** Blue colour is used to show water features or water bodies (Rivers, Lakes, ponds, tanks, wells, etc.,)
- **Green** - Wooded and forested areas shown as green wash, orchards, scattered trees and scrubs shown by green symbols.
- **Yellow** - Cultivated areas are shown as yellow wash.
- **Red** - Grid lines (East and North) and their numbering; roads, cart track and foot path, settlements, huts and buildings are shown in red.
- **White patches** - Uncultivated land and glaciated and snow covered areas in mountains. (Figure 11.1)

11.3 Open Series Maps

Survey of India (SOI) brings out two series of maps through the National Map Policy, 2005.

1) Defence Series Maps (DSMs) - These topographical maps (on Everest/ WGS-84 Datum and Polyconic/UTM Projection) are on various scales (with heights, contours and full content without dilution of accuracy). These maps mainly cater for defence and national securityrequirements. This series of maps (in analogue or digital forms) for the entire country are classified by the Ministry of Defence.

2) Open Series Maps (OSMs) - OSMs are brought out exclusively by SOI, primarily for supporting development activities in the country. OSMs bear different map sheet numbers and are in UTM Projection on WGS-84 datum. Each of these OSMs (in both hard copy and digital form) become'Unrestricted'.

11.4 Marginal Information

Marginal information includes the topographical sheet number, its location, grid references, its extent in degrees and

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